This ratio of 3 :1 in the F_2 suggests that the hybrids or heterozygotes of F_1 generation have two contrasting factors or alleles of dominant and recessive type. These factors, though remain together for a long time, do not contaminate or mix with each other. They separate or segregate at the time of gamete formation so that a gamete carries only one factor, either dominat or recessive.

Precautions:

1. Take a sufficiently large number of seeds for analysis to minimise the error.
2. Observe the contrasting form of trait carefully.

Exercise 10: Analysis of seed sample to study Mendelian dihybrid ratio

Aim:

To analyse seed sample of pea for Mendelian dihybrid ratio of 9 : 3 : 3 : 1.

Principle:

In a dihyrbid cross, the segregation of one gene pair is independent of the segregation of the other pair. It means that when the factors (genes) for different characters inherited from parents do not remain linked in the offsprings, but their distribution in the gametes and in the progeny of subsequent generations is independent of each other.

Requirement:

Plastic beakers, Pea seed samples or plastic beads, tray, petri dishes, notebook, pencil / pen.

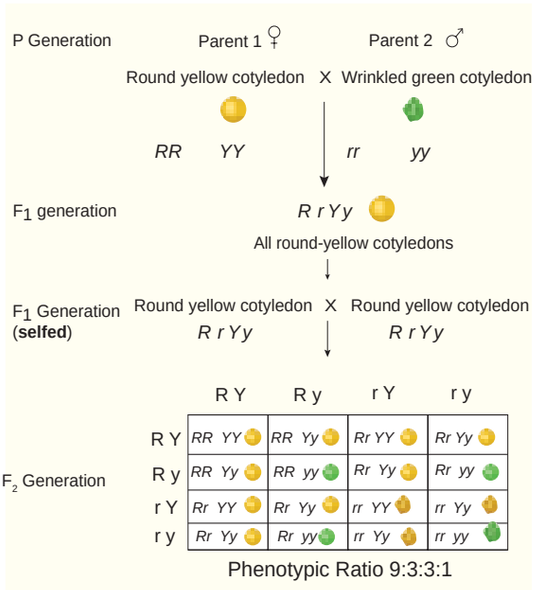


Figure 10 : Dihybrid cross

Teachers should select the Pea seed or plastic beads which represents the four types of traits such as yellow round, yellow wrinkled, green round and green wrinkled in the ratio of 9:3:3:1

Procedure:

1. Take a lot of about 160 Pea seeds or plastic beads in a tray.
2. Separate out yellow round, yellow wrinkled, green round and green wrinkled and put them in separate petridishes.
3. Note down the number of seeds in each plate and find out their approximate ratio.

Observation:

Present your finding in the form of a table.

Total Number of seeds observed	No. of yellow round seeds	No. of yellow wrinkled seeds	No. of green round seeds	No. of green wrinkled seeds	Approximate ratio
160	90	30	30	10	9 : 3:3:1

Inference:

The ratio of yellow round : yellow wrinkled : Green round : green wrinkled is approximately 9 : 3 : 3 : 1 which is exactly the same as obtained by Mendel for a dihybrid cross. This indicates that the contrasting genes for seed colour and seed shape show an independent assortment in the population of pea seeds.

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